Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology

Shehara Handicrafts

Website/ Mobile Application Redesign Project 2025

E-Business: Strategies Design & Architecture- IE3051

Group NO:06

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Submitted to:
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1. Introduction

Shehara Handicrafts is a Sri Lankan company that has spent more than 25 years being involved in the manufacturing and trading of authentic handmade products locally and internationally. The company is known to be one of the most important actors in native cultural heritage conservation and proliferation since they use the home artisans to promote their craftwork. These artisans use techniques that have been passed down through generations, ensuring that the craftsmanship remains alive for future generations.

The company's products consist of a massive 15,000 pieces, such as karadu, silver jewelry, metalwork in brass, copper, and silver, woodcarvings, batiks, masks, lacquerware, pottery, handwoven rush and reed products, hand-embroidered linen, and coconut-based products. Therefore, the primary purpose of Shehara Handicrafts is to give the target audience, mainly local international Buddhists, an opportunity to buy handcrafted items of high quality and at the same time support the local artisan community.

Shehara Handicrafts is a company that has been quite consistent through the years in terms of being a source for its clients of unique and high-quality items that tell and reflect the traditional heritage of Sri Lanka. The company's initiatives stand beside attempts to keep pure the traditions of craftsmanship and to create products, which are not only artists' originalities but also objects of everyday use. The company's official website serves as a primary digital platform for exhibiting the variety of handcrafted products on offer.

The webpage of the company address enables the organization to connect with both local and international customers, sell Sri Lankan handicrafts, and promote Sri Lankan artisanal traditions. This website is also important for the company's branding and allows them to manage their interactions with the firm and learn about its mission, vision and various offerings.

This report walks through a case where the website is reviewed and redesigned using “Figma” UX/UI designs. The goal of the renovation is to make it more user-friendly, mobile-ready, visually adept, and aligned with the latest in e-commerce technology so that it will not only reflect the organization’s image better but also enhance the user experience and help to achieve desired future growth.

2. Identified Problems

As the first task, gathered requirements of the current website by interviewing the owner of the company through an online meeting.

- **Outdated Design:** The styles are ruined by the ancient appearance of the website, and in turn, the latter is absent not only in user interaction but also in the weak brand perception.
- **Navigation Issues:** The various menu structures and the chaotic navigation of the pages not only give a very bad impression on the usability of the site, but it also prevents users from browsing the site effectively.
- **Inefficient Product Display:** It is almost impossible for users to make well-informed buying decisions as the product details provided and images seem to be unclear and of low quality.
- **Absence of Search Functionality:** The absence of a search bar makes users waste valuable time and increase their irritation with slow and ineffective browsing, as they are not able to quickly find products they want.
- **Lack of Customer Engagement Features:** No reviews, and testimonials, this means that no new customer can have a one-on-one interaction with previous clients that would make them trust the brand name.
- **Faulty Payment Process:** The problem of the defective payment process that is undesirable is caused by the fact that when a product is clicked on it does not lead to checkout but just the page is reloaded, hence, the user is deprived of the possibility to make a purchase.

- **Broken Pages (404 Errors):** The presence of 404 errors on several pages is responsible for inconveniences to the users and has a huge impact on the credibility of the website and its usability.
- **Unclear Text on Images:** The unclear text over the images presented is either due to the contrast being poor or the resolution being low or maybe even the placement not being the best.
- **Inconsistent Visual Elements:** The major downside caused by the mixing of colors, fonts, and sizes in a design is that the user experience with a poor appearance and readability of the content is affected.
- **FAQ Page:** The existing FAQ linked page in the footer opens a non-existing page, that may lead to the confusion of users and a decrease in their trust on the website.
- **Lack of Efficiency in Category Navigation:** In the navigation bar, Product categories such as Karadu, Brass or Silver redirect all users to a singular product page rather than an individual category page. This greatly diminishes users' browsing efficiency as they are forced to sort through the various products.

3. Proposed Solutions

Considering the user satisfaction and goals, users will achieve optimum satisfaction when an increased level of interactivity with the site is made possible through:

- **Improvement of Website User Interface:** Redesign the site's interface to a more modern style with attention to branding, whitespace, visual hierarchy, and unified thematic elements.
- **Enhancement of Navigation System:** Set up the menus in a manner where they are grouped logically. This also requires implementing breadcrumbs and a breadcrumb trail, if necessary, to enable effortless movement around the site.
- **Improve Text Readability on Images:** Employ different filters, backdrop, or shadings that will color text to make it more visible without covering engaging parts of an image. Text should be placed strategically for maximum readability.

- **Enhancement of Listings Features**: Improve product descriptions, specifications, pricing info, add high quality images which will be zoomable. Consider adding product videos for the inclusion of richer content.
- **Implementation of Advanced Search Functions:** Enable searching by keywords, categories, prices, and other criteria with a fast, predictive search bar. Implement advanced search tools.
- **Add Customer Engagement Features:** Integrate photos, reviews, testimonials and star ratings. These features are useful for trust and improving sales.
- **Fix The Payment Process Flow:** Smooth any broken flows from product selection to the stage of payment. Routinely test all gateways and payment forms to ensure proper functionality.
- **Resolve 404 Errors:** Perform audits and checks for all missing pages and lose links to capture and fix all 404 errors. Redirect to proper site pages and use 301/302 for redirecting.
- **Unify Visual Elements:** Standardize color palettes, font types, and sizes across every page. Develop a brand and style guide and thus enhance brand cohesion.
- **Create A Functional FAQ Section:** Populate an accordion style FAQ section and correctly hyperlink it to the footer. Link all frequent questions to relevant pages to capture user interest.
- **Add a Feedback Page:** Create a standalone feedback page on which all customers can leave comments, suggestions, and concerns. This page will be beneficial for the improvement of the website while also gaining an understanding of the customers' needs and preferences.
- **Set up all categories in one page in the navigation bar:** all brass, silver, and karadu products in one page and after logging that page can choose the products separately. It helps to get a more prefect website.

4. Sketches of the Website

1)Home page and About Us Page

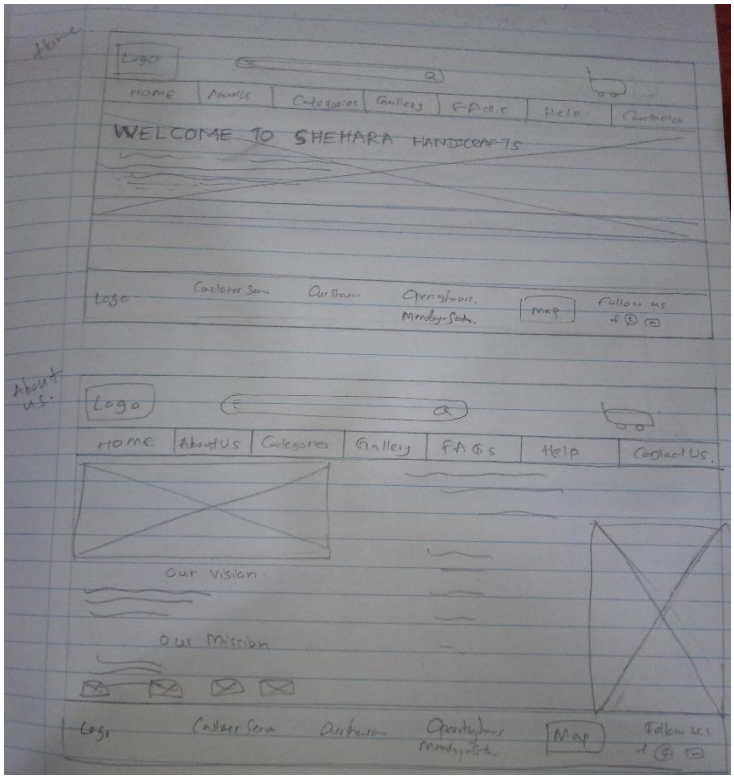

Figure 4: Home Page & About Us Page

3)Single Product View page and FAQs Page

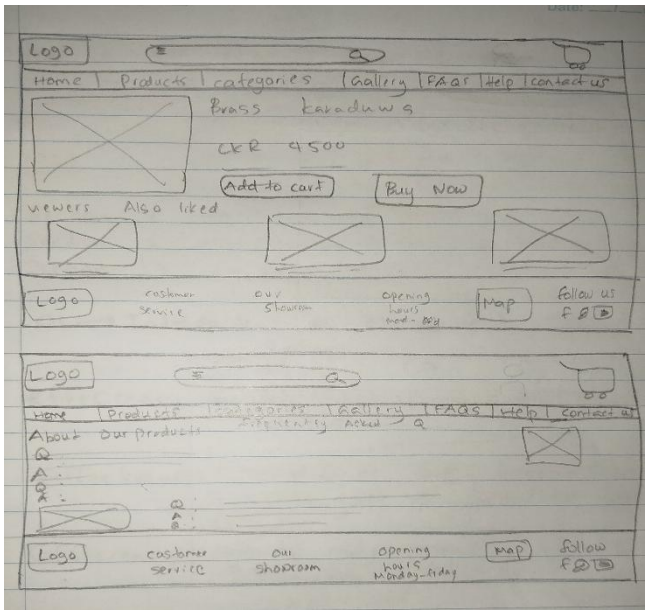

Figure 1: Single Product View page and FAQs

2)Categories page and Gallery Page

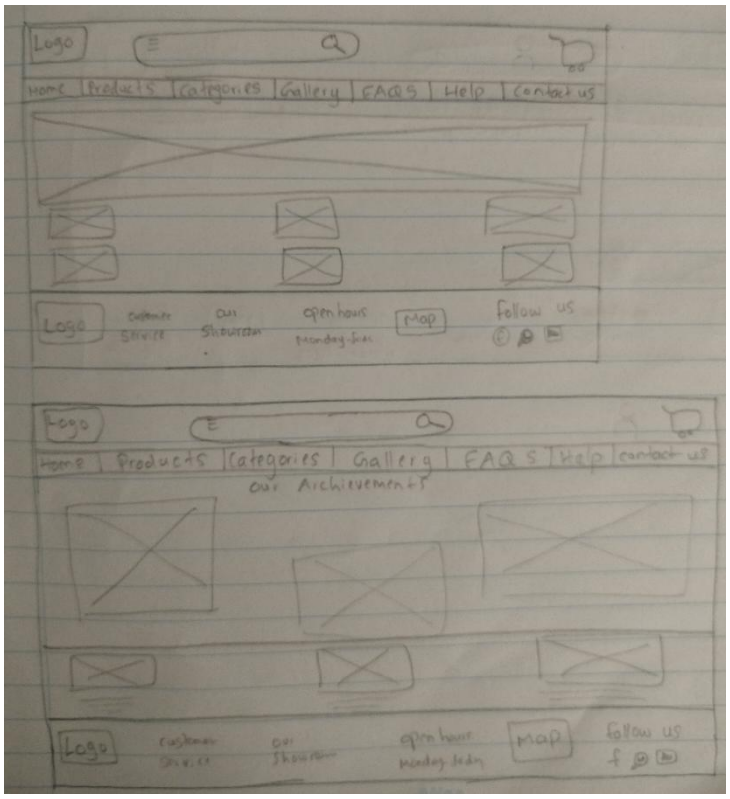

Figure 3: Categories page and Gallery Page

4)Contact Us page and Help Page

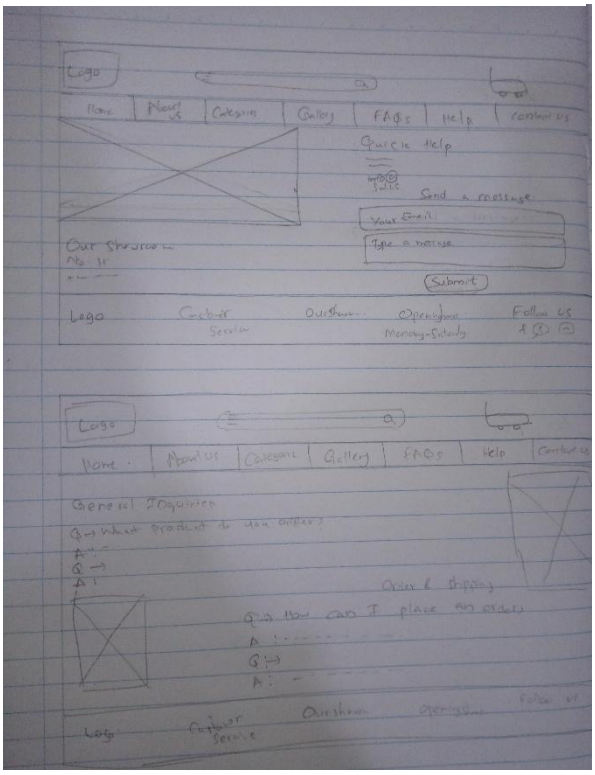

Figure 2: Contact Us page and Help Page

5)Delivery Information page and Feedback Page

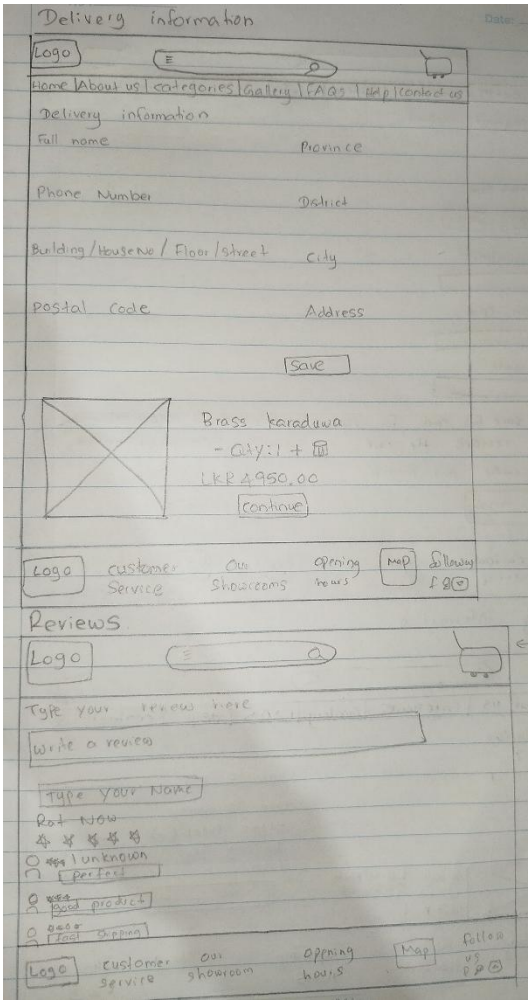

Figure 7: Delivery Information page and Feedback Page

6)Payment page and Delivery Information Page

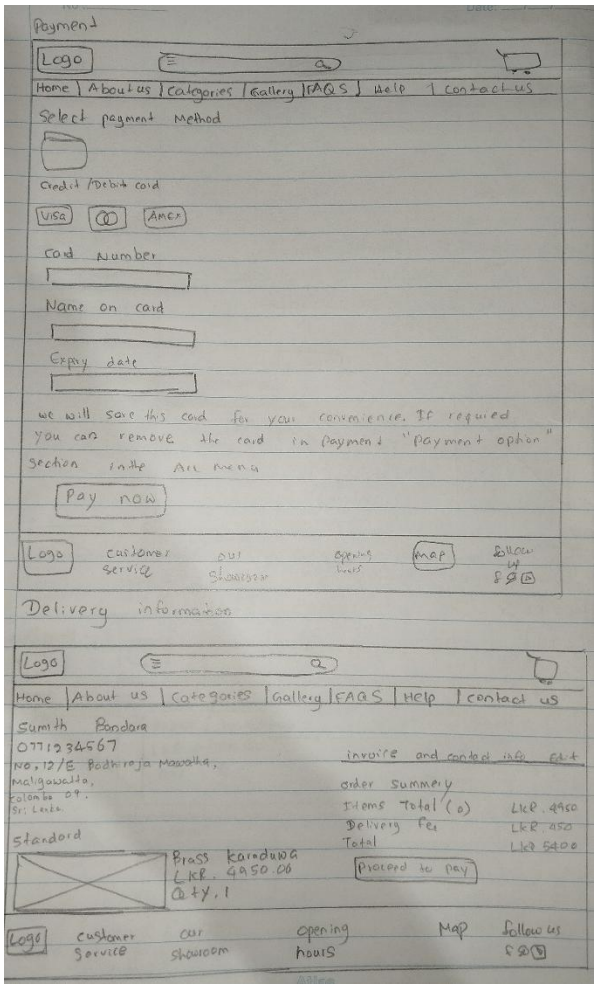

Figure 6: Payment page and Delivery Information Page

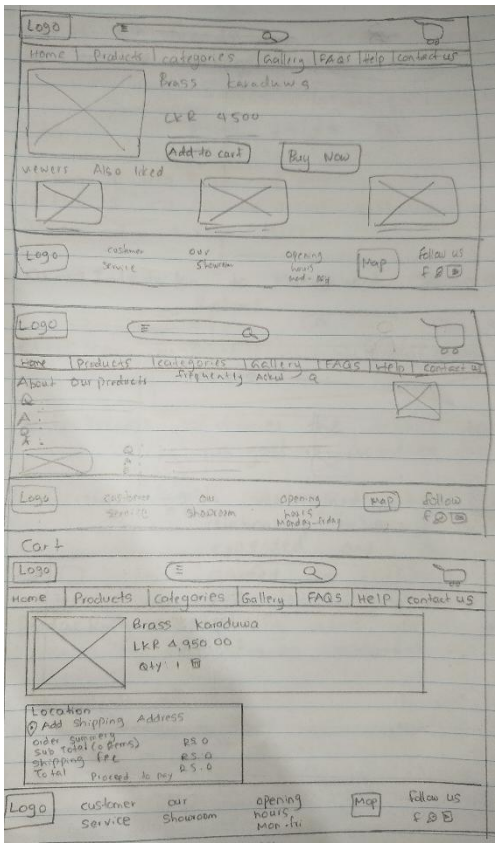

Figure 5:Delivery Information Page and Cart Page

7) Delivery Information Page and Cart Page

5. Wireframes

1) Home Page, About Us Page
   And
   Gallery Page

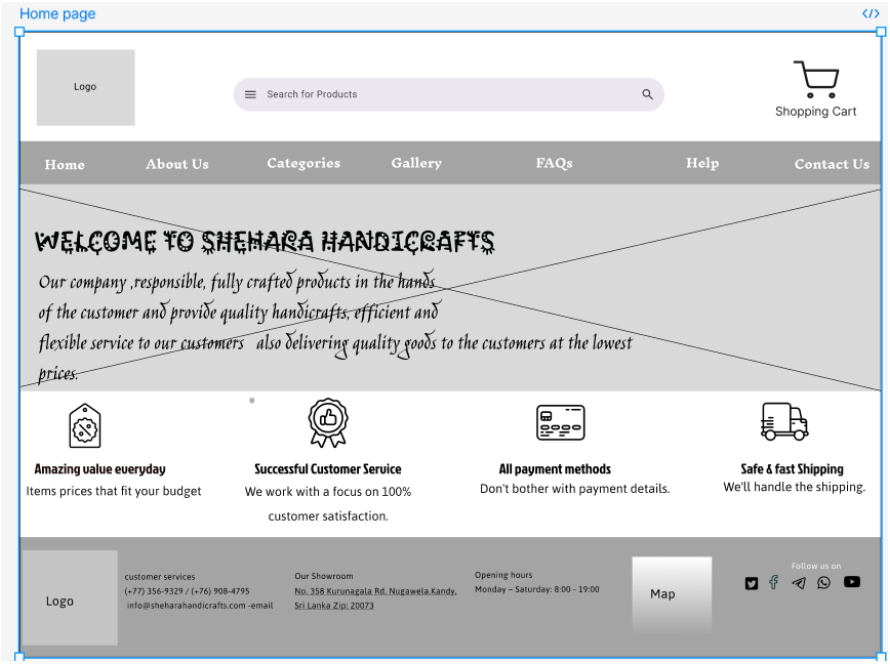

Figure 8:Home Page Wireframe

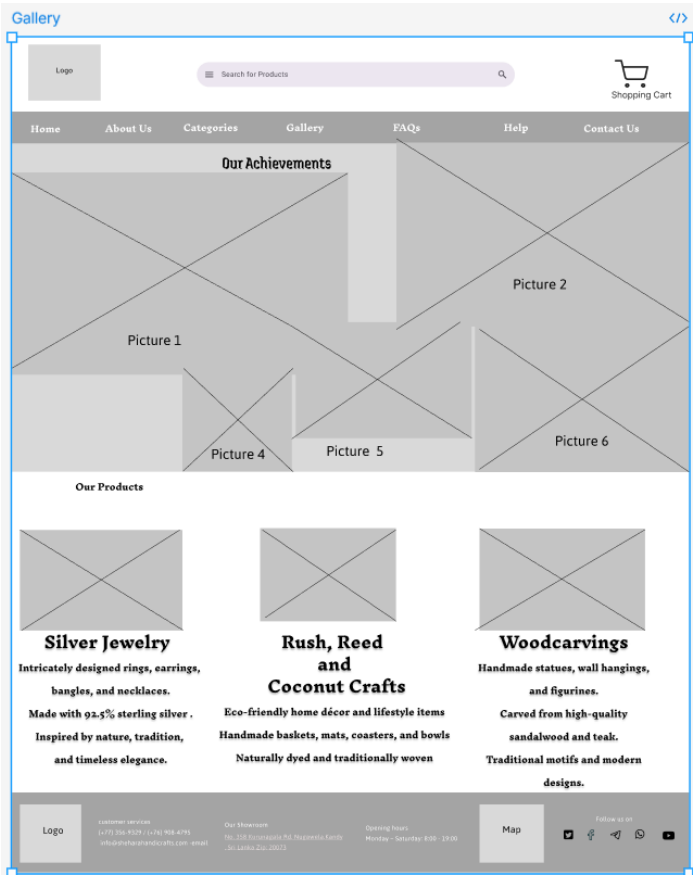

Figure 9:Gallery Page Wireframe

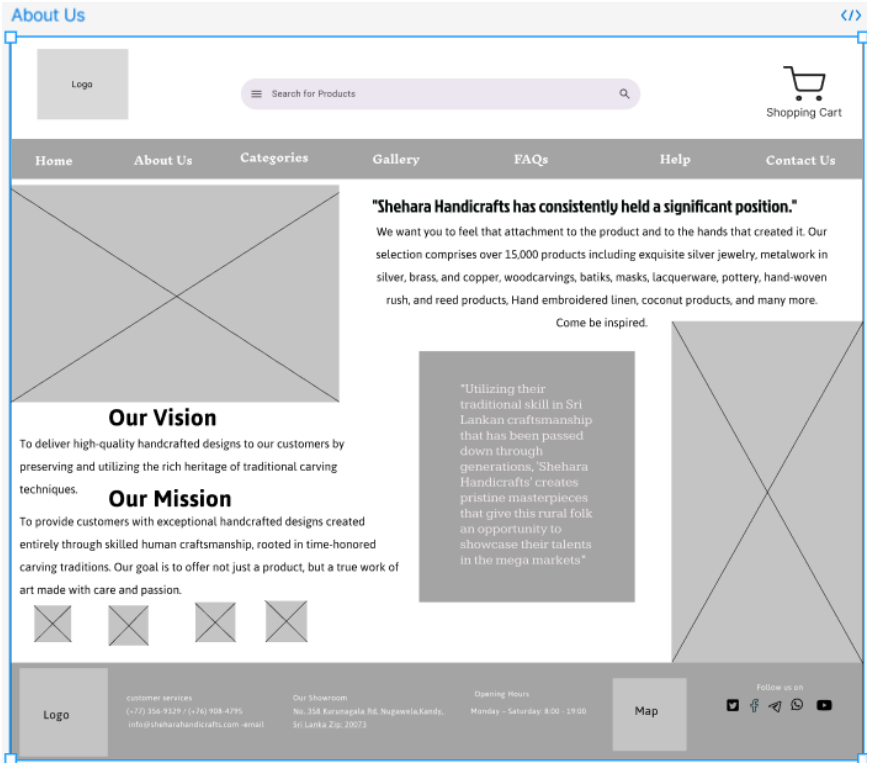

Figure 10:About Us Page Wireframe

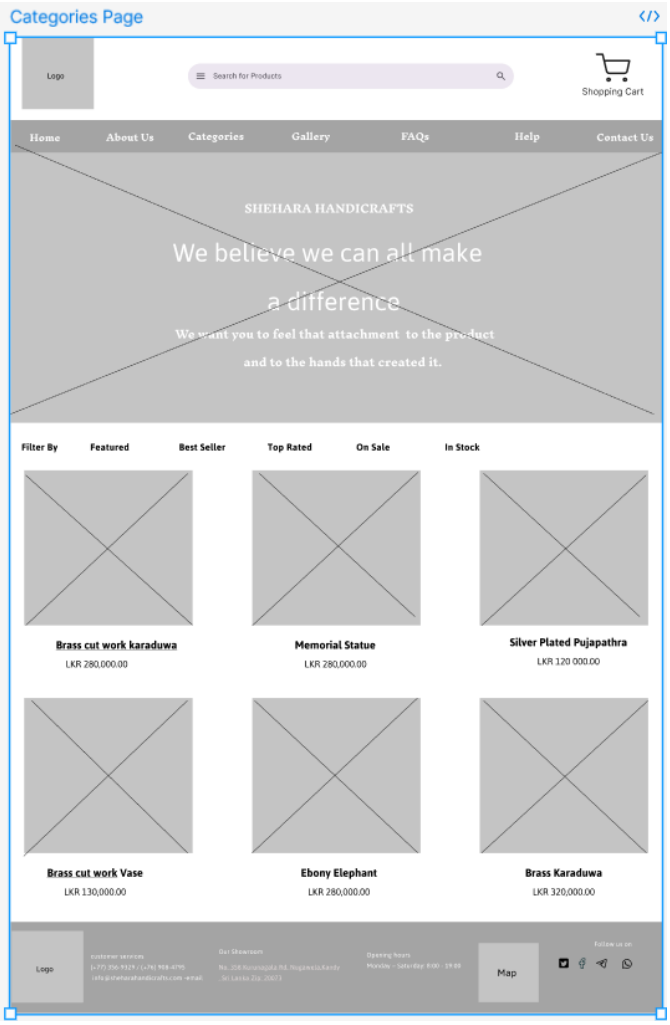

Figure 11:Categories Page Wireframe

2) Categories Page, Single Product View Page And
FAQs Page

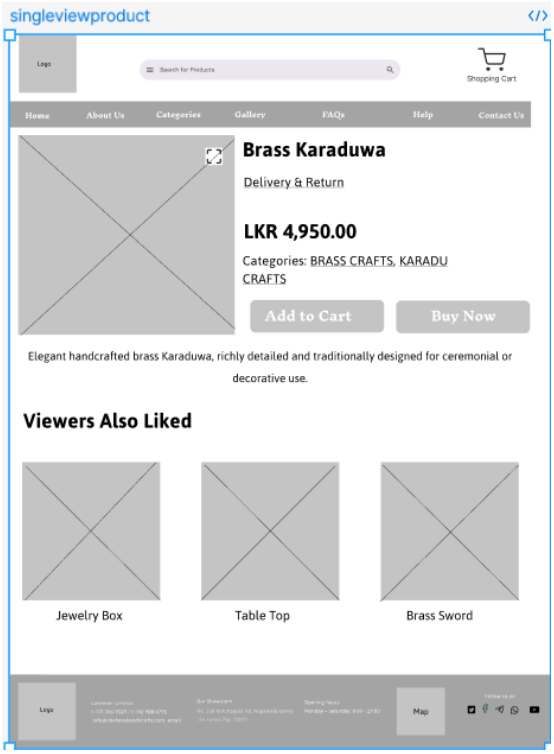

Figure 12:Single Product View Page Wireframe

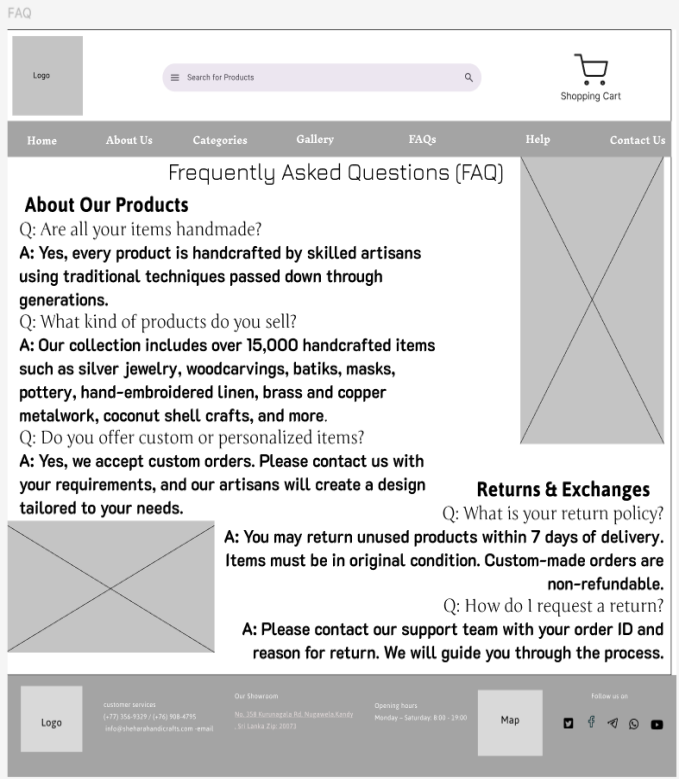

Figure 13:FAQs Page Wireframe

3) Reviews Page, Contact Us Page
And
Help Page

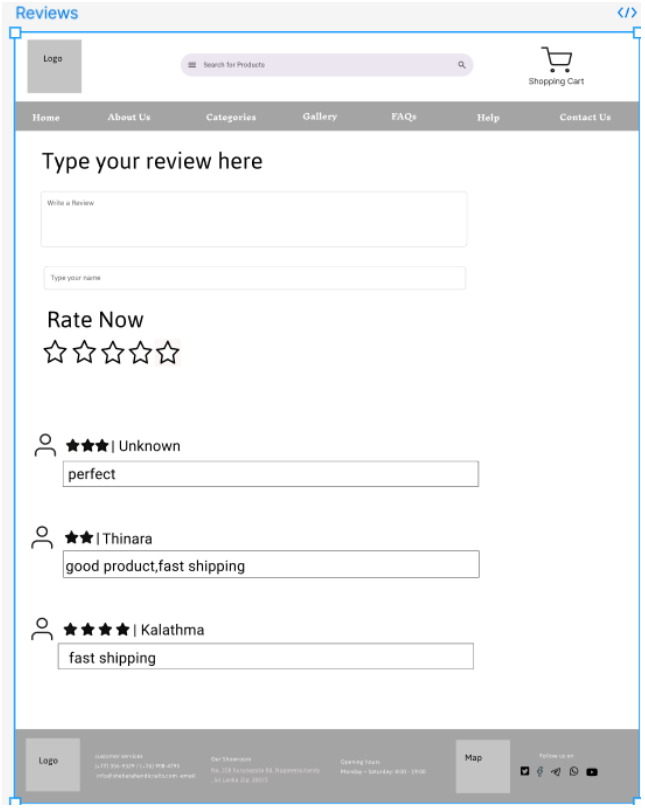

Figure 14:Reviews Page Wireframe

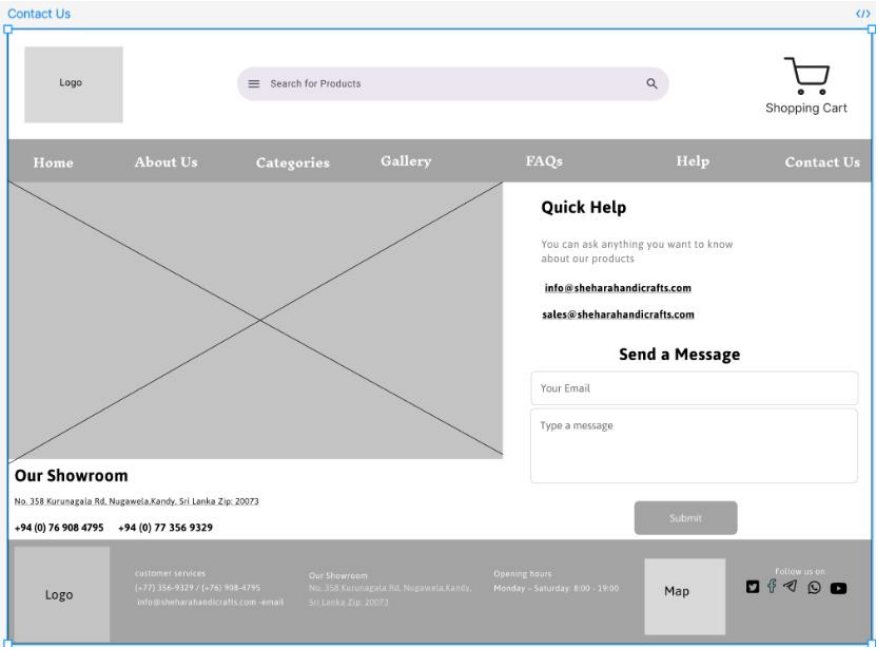

Figure 15:Contact Us Page Wireframe

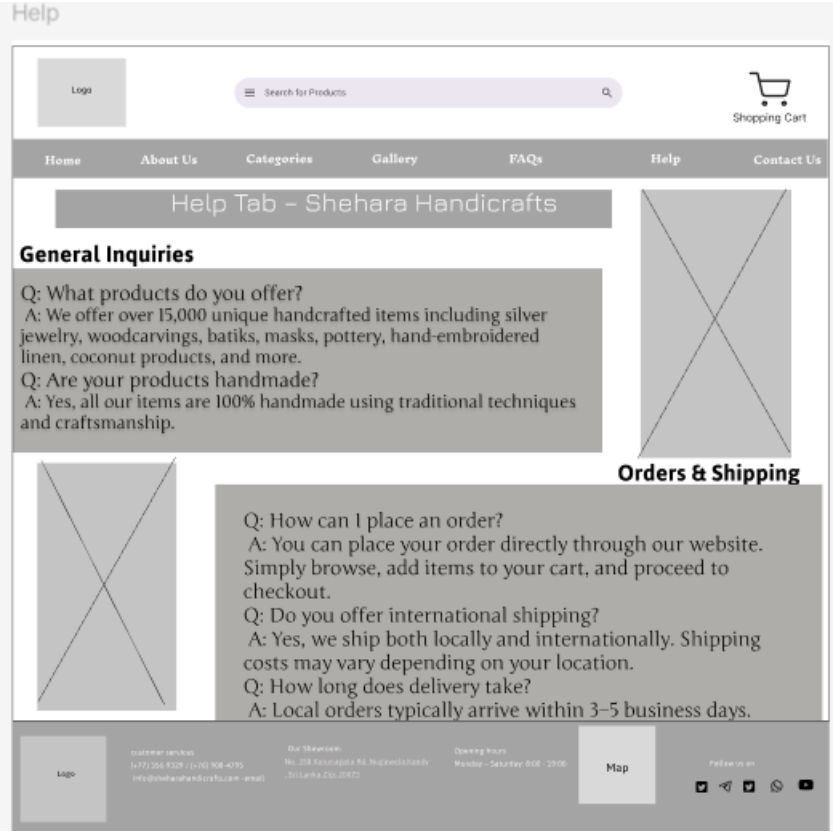

Figure 16:Help Page Wireframe

4) Cart Page, Delivery Information Page And
Payment Page

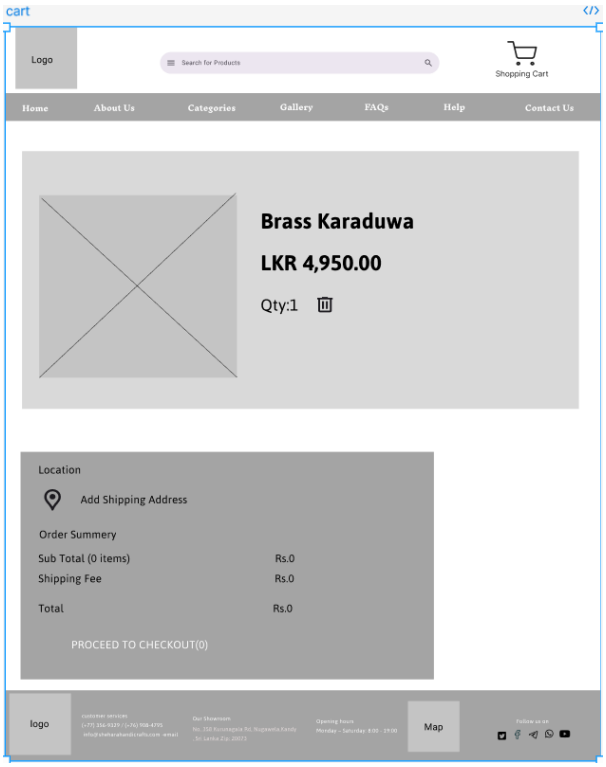

Figure 17:Cart Page Wireframe

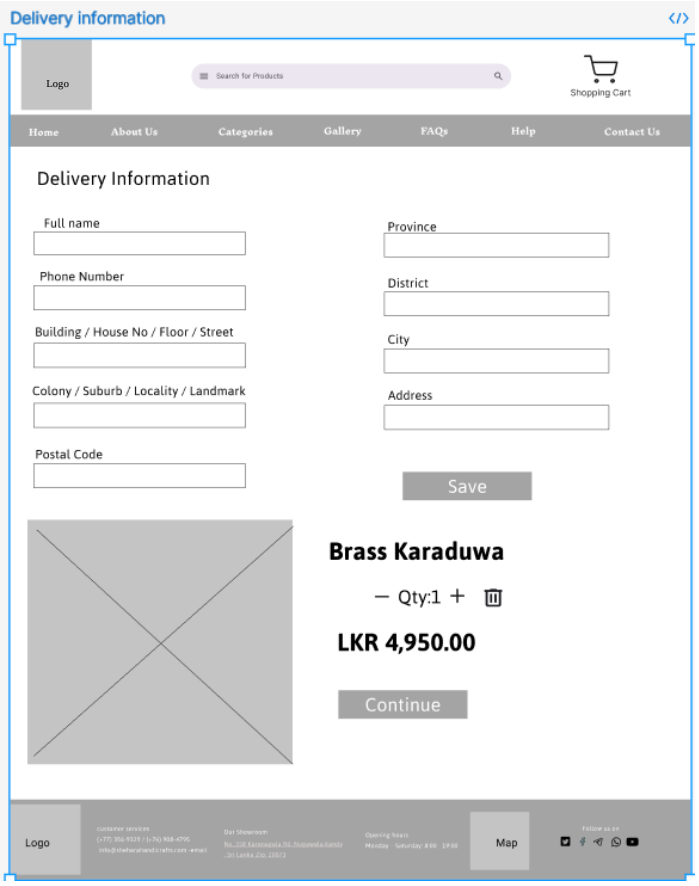

Figure 18:Delivery Information1 Wireframe

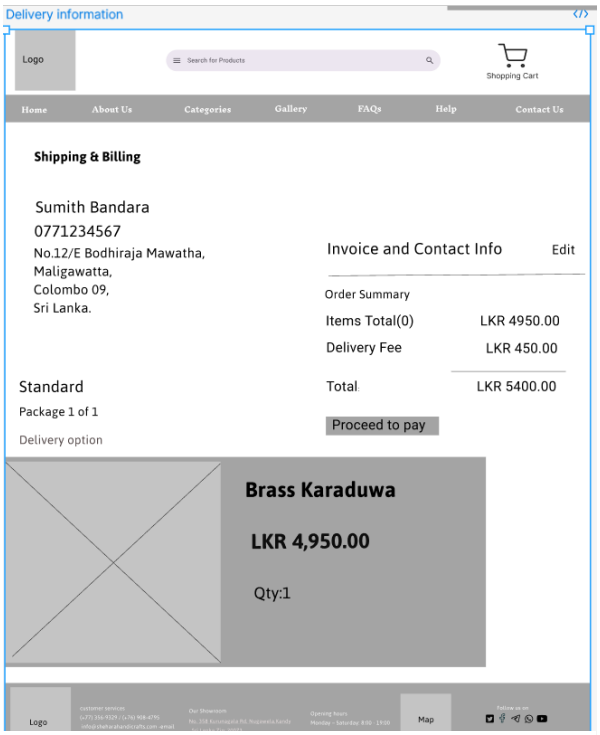

Figure 19:Delivery Information2 Wireframe

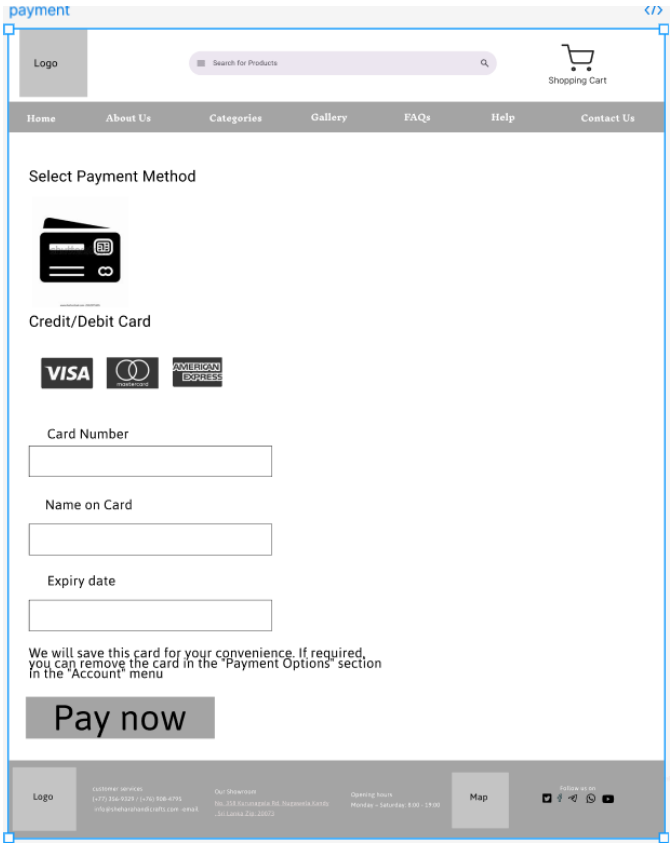

Figure 20:Payment Wireframe

6. Mockup and Prototype Explanation

The mockups offer a fixed image of the Shehara Handicrafts website, which has gone through some updates. These designs articulate the arrangement, graphical hierarchy and interface elements of exigent pages using Figma. The aim is to improve UX while maintaining the traditional look and feel, as well as guiding users to navigate with ease.

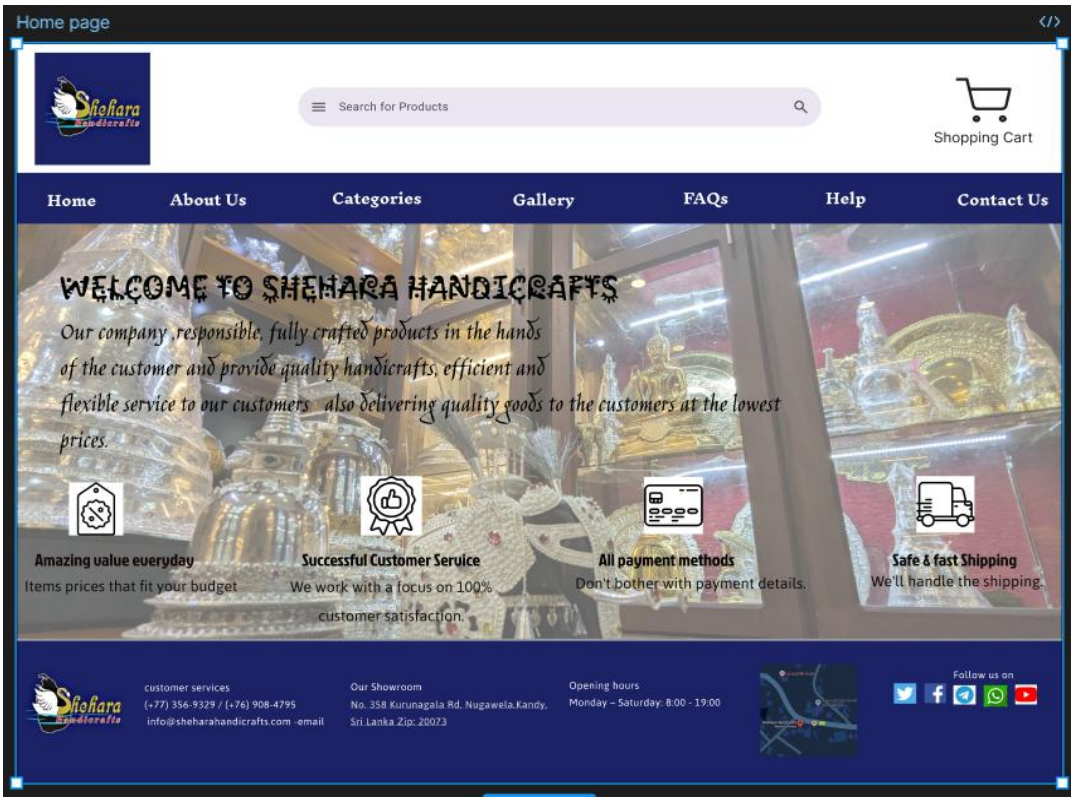

Figure 21: Home Page

Homepage: The homepage mockup portrays a modern and sleek structure that orients users to the brand's identity alongside the product offerings. To capture User's attention instantly and direct them to the relevant key product areas.

It incorporates:

- A rotating hero banner containing promotional images.
- The navigation bar is simplified and streamlined containing product categories.
- Sections showcasing featured products and traditional crafts.
- A footer containing contact details, social media links, and a newsletter subscription form.

Categories Page in navigation bar: The page is organized using a grid layout which categorizes products into specific groups. This aid is helpful to enable users to effectively navigate and narrow down their search based on their preferences.

It features:

- Product thumbnail images that are well-structured.
- Show Hover effects that display quick-view or “Add to Cart” options.
- Sidebar filters are based on categories, price, and material.

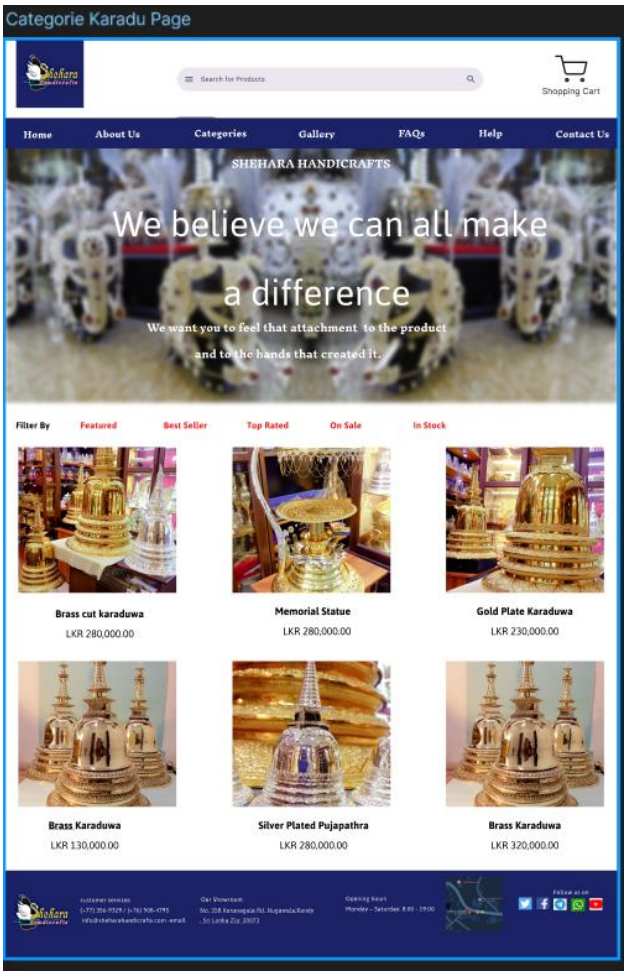

Figure 22: Category Karadu Page

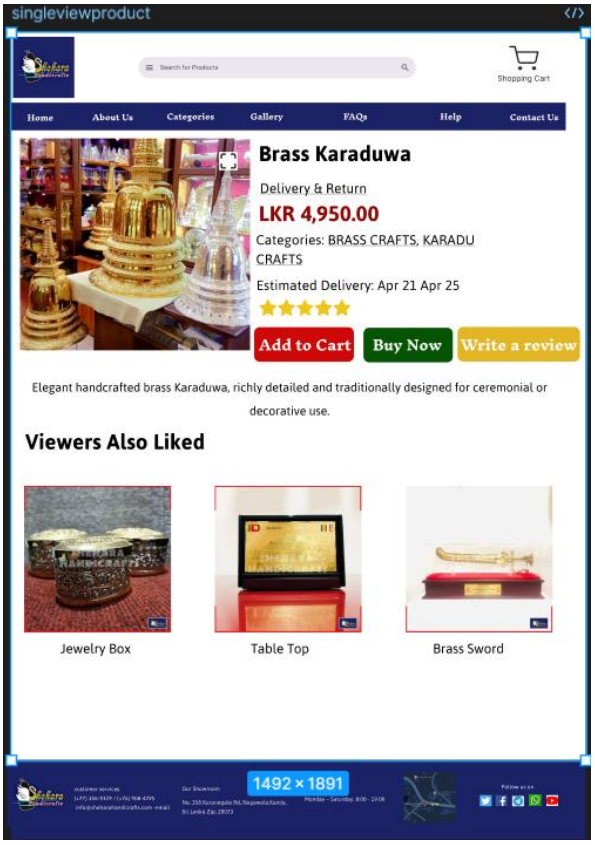

Figure 23: Single Product View Page

Product Detail Page: A specific page is provided for every product. This ensures that the customers are adequately informed about all product information, thereby improving their confidence in making a purchase.

- A primary image of the product together with several views.
- The full description of the product, the price, and specifications detail.
- An “Add to Cart” button “Buy Now” action buttons.
- Suggestions for related products.

Cart and Checkout Pages: These pages enable efficient purchasing. To reduce the number of incomplete purchases and optimize the transaction flow.

- A cart summary with adjustable quantities and item previews.
- A three-stage checkout (Shipping → Payment → Confirmation).
- Review and confirmation of the order interface.

Feedback Pages: in the feedback pages users can review the service and comment about the service

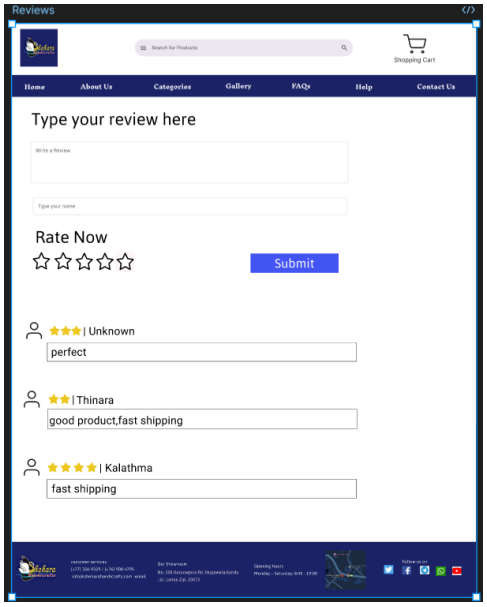

Figure 25:Feedback Page

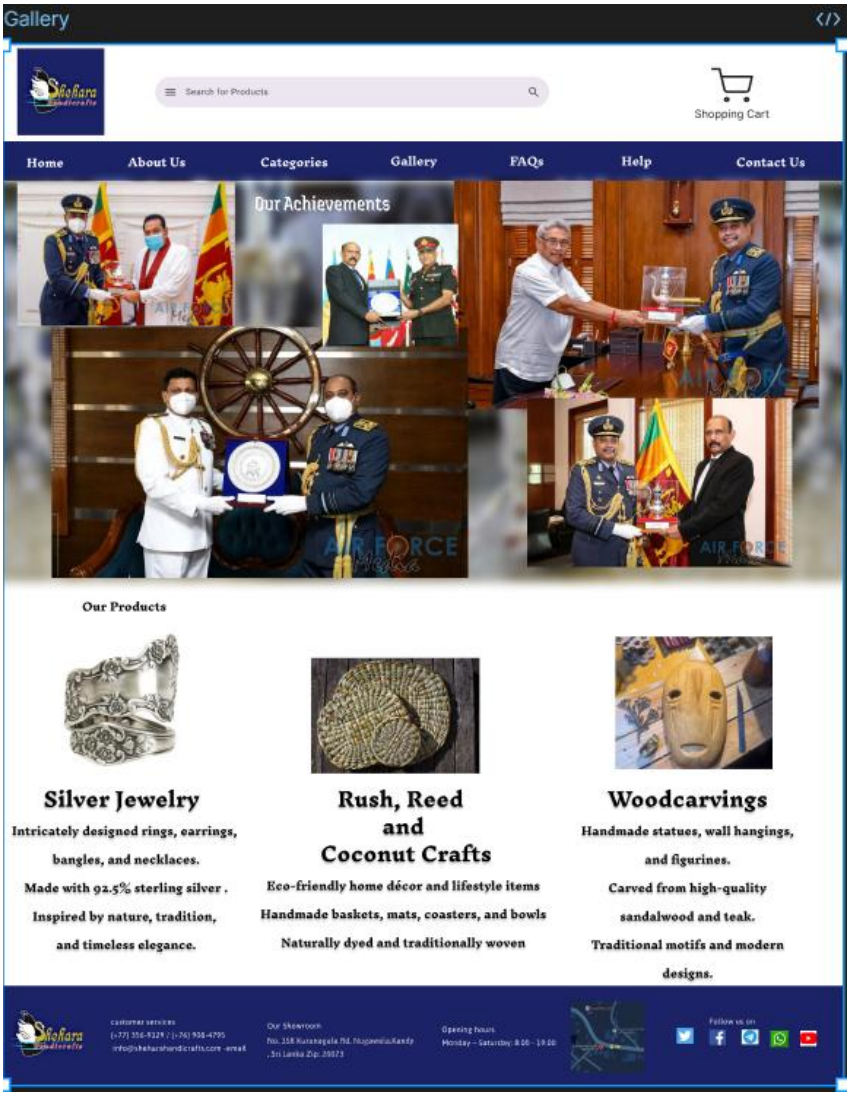

Figure 24:Gallery Page

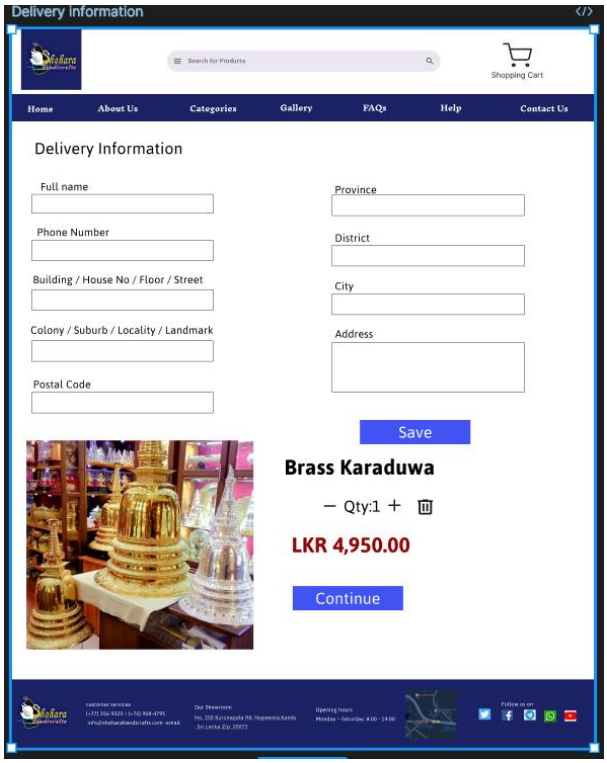

Figure 26:Delivery Information Page

Prototype Explanation: The Figma application performed the redesign of the Shehara Handicrafts website's interactive prototype. Figma is a collaboration UI/UX design tool. The prototype shows users important journeys and interfaces for them to engage with the Interface Interaction Model. Not quite a working site, the prototype accurately simulates the interaction with menus, screen resizing, and other functions within the site. Here shows the mockup and prototype redesigned Figma design.

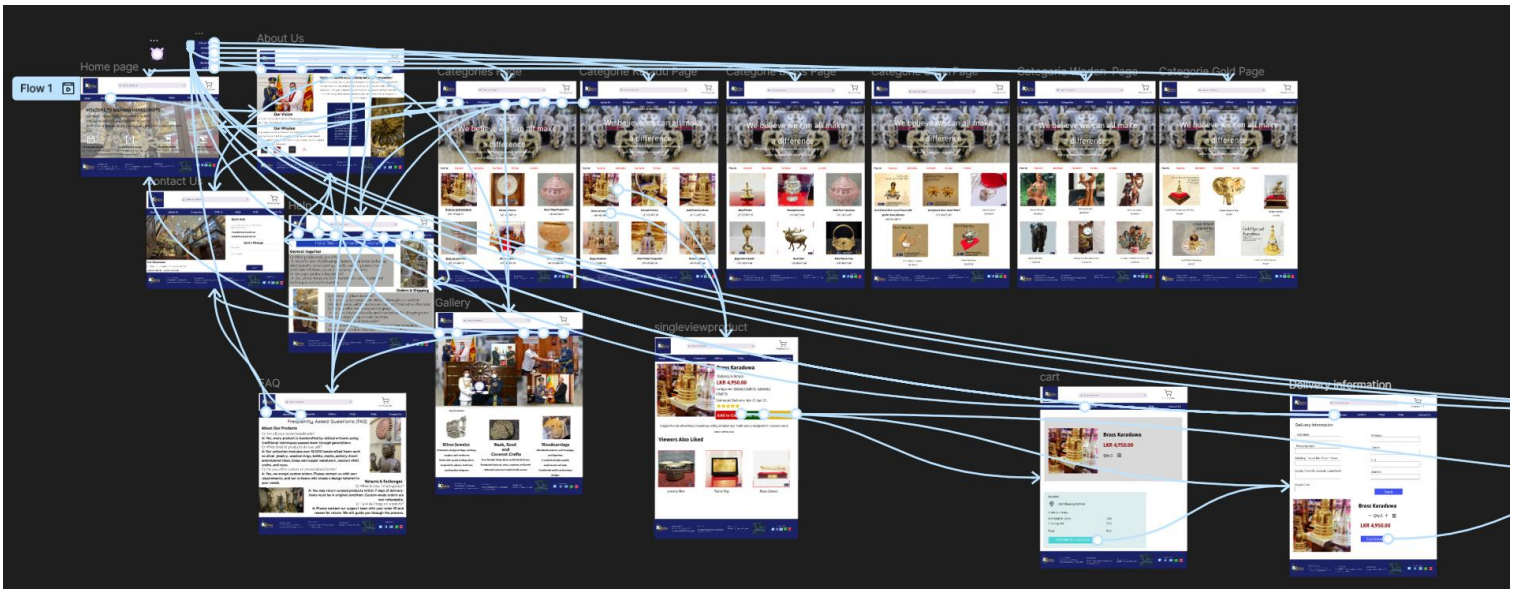

Figure 27: mockup, prototype and redesign Figma design

Responsive Interactive Navigation Bar: The navigation bar has been fully implemented in the prototype including dropdowns to allow user interaction.

Responsive layout: Cut frames done to show desktop view and mobile view separately.

Images and Buttons Feature Hover and Animation: Users can hover over buttons images to receive feedback and animations, these include “Add to Cart” and “Shop Now”.

Simulation of adding items to the shopping cart: Selecting “Add to Cart” allows users to view a modal which updates the cart to show items added.

7. Advantages of Redesigned Website

Redesigning the site resolves usability and performance issues and adds user satisfaction along with business credibility and operational productivity. The overall impact adds the following benefits:

Improve User Experience:

A modern look guides users through navigation scaffolding aiding them in finding the required information with ease and is accessible in no time and successful payments.

Enhanced Customer Trust:

Building trust alongside the likes of product information alongside customer reviews and testimonials fosters strong customer loyalty.

Efficient Search and Navigation:

Improved site usability as users can readily locate the product or content that they need in no time on the website via the robust search aids as well as operational filters.

Reducing Bounce Rate:

Users are encouraged to browse more when broken links are fixed, content errors are corrected, and the information presented is easily digestible.

Technical Reliability:

The website works seamlessly across different browsers and devices, ensuring uniform visual design and accessibility for every user.

Improved Ranking in Search Engines:

A website is better ranked on search engine results when its content can be conveniently accessed, is presented via clean URLs, and mobile-friendly SEO practices are followed.

Uniform Visuals:

Cultivated via standardization of typography, color, and design elements which results in consistent style.

Active FAQ Page:

Reduces confusion while providing users with easy access to support.

8. Limitations

Even though the intended redesign of the website seeks to enhance its usability, aesthetics, and functionality, the following potential implementation constraints have been identified:

- Design Constraints Due to Business Rules: The logo of the company is out of shape, as noted by the design team, but it cannot be altered owing to the owner's stubbornness. This restriction undermines branding and design flexibility.

- Team Skill Development Requirements: The design team is aware of the need to take additional training in modern web design practices and tools which could impede the project schedule. This may impact productivity and delivery timelines of workflows within the redesign process.

- Time Constraints and Academic Commitments: This redesign project needs to be completed during a busy academic phase, which expands the overall workload available to the team. Hence, there might be dependency and resource constraints in the progress towards milestone deadlines.

- Remote Communication and Coordination: All collaboration regarding the company has been conducted online using Microsoft Teams, since they are located far from the company.

- Target audience Preferences unclear: There is no user research or user feedback data available particularly for website users from the company. In turn, this information gap severely limits tailoring the new design to specific audience needs and tastes.

9.Conclusion

The redesign of the Shehara Handicrafts website is critical in bridging the gap between the digital world and the company's heritage as well as its aspirations going forward. The site captures the beauty of Sri Lankan culture and craftsmanship; however, it is out of date and does not align with modern user expectations norms like responsiveness, usability, and overall user experience. The redesign seeks to resolve optimally, a myriad of issues the website faces, including, broken links, outdated aesthetics, mobile unfriendliness, non-responsive design, and various other technical problems.

With smooth navigation, improved product showcasing, modern UI/UX implementation, and customer interaction features such as product reviews and advanced search capabilities, the website will serve as a true representation of Sri Lankan artistry while greatly enhancing customer interaction. In addition, the new design will improve trust in the brand that is bound to lead to elevated sales and better brand recognition.

Despite some restrictions like branding, skill development, and time limitations, the redesign project still emerges as purposeful and impactful. It has the potential to create a more functional and visually appealing online presence that highlights and celebrates the intricate craftsmanship of Shehara Handicrafts, while aiding sustained growth in regional and international markets.